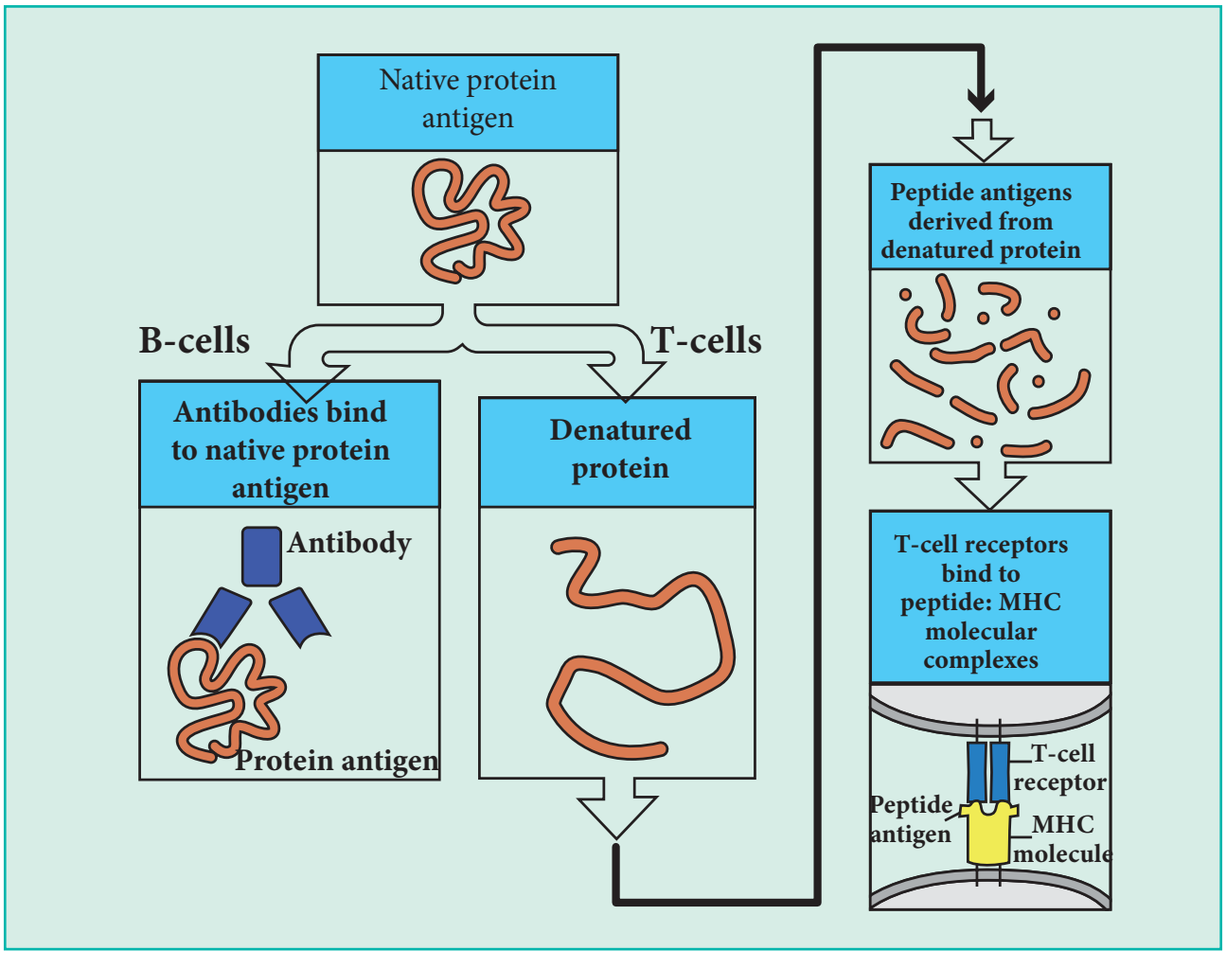
10.4. ANTIGENS

Antigens are foreign substances that have an ability to induce antibody generation. Antigenic determinant or epitope is the region of the antigen recognized by antibodies or T-Cell Receptor (TCR) of T cells. There are two types of epitopes namely B cell epitope and T cell epitope. B cell epitope is the region of antigen recognized by antibodies. T cell epitope is the region of antigen recognized by TCR of T cells.



10.4.1. Types of antigens

Sl. No.	Types of Antigens	Nature	Example
1.	Sequestered antigens	These antigens are secluded or sequestered in capsule i.e. it is not exposed to immune system during development or when produced.	Lens proteins and sperm proteins.
2.	Neoantigens	They are newly produced antigens i.e. normal agents become antigens. They are formed due to the change in the chemical, physical and biological status of the agents.	Penicillin can be converted to neoantigen when it is bound with protein.

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